



UDENRIGSMINISTERIET

PRIVILEGEREDE INSTRUKTIONER

PRIVILEGED INSTRUCTIONS

**Ministry of Foreign Affairs
KINGDOM OF DENMARK**



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*Ministry of Foreign Affairs
of Denmark*

**MINISTRY OF FOREIGN AFFAIRS
OF DENMARK**

Privileged Instructions

Fundamental Principles

- Through Grønland (Greenland) we are an Arctic nation.
- We will resolve all boundary issues in accordance with international law.

Desired End States

- PRIMARY: Grønland's territorial integrity is preserved and its resources developed by its people's desires.
- ALTERNATE: Peaceful resolution to all boundary issues.
- Additional details tied to end states above:
 - The continental shelf determination issue is resolved.
 - Pituffik Space Base remains as a military deterrent to Russia.

Primary Guidance Background

Increased interest in Grønland's mineral wealth has brought many foreign governments to seek stakes. Australia, Canada, and China are pressuring for agreements to mine precious metals and gems. Though Grønland has autonomy to develop their own natural resources we must balance their international relationship interactions, which the Crown controls. The Naalakkersuisut has recently banned mineral extraction within their territory.

We are responsible for the Kingdom's foreign policy, and we must balance decisions we make with the potential for Grønland's full independence. They have the right to vote on a referendum for independence and have yet to exercise it. The vast economic wealth potential, in the EEZ surrounding Grønland, would first pay the subsidies we provide to Grønland and then the rest would directly profit them.

To other nation-states it must appear that we are a coherent entity with Grønland and that we speak from a common voice. There is a delicate balance to be played, due to the Naalakkersuisut's positions, but foreign entities must view our policies as unified.

Delegation Instructions

Ensure periodic reports, requests for further guidance, or clarifications to the instructions herein are submitted via message to the office of the Foreign Minister.

GENERAL: Below are our negotiation positions during for this conference. Deviation from these instructions is to be conferred with the Foreign Minister prior to negotiating.

We can expect increased activity throughout the Arctic in the coming decades. New opportunities and challenges must be handled proactively. Care and accountability must accompany all decisions regarding the policies developed in governing this region. The Kingdom must play a key role in the future international cooperation that lies ahead.

Utilize the 'Arctic 5' group of nations in all discussions regarding the Arctic Ocean and the coastal states that have natural rights to its development. Iceland, Finland, and Sweden should have no say in the policies set forth for these particular economic discussions.

Territory

We have considerable interest in the Arctic. We have a duty to protect our nation against foreign aggression as well as maintain control over our territory. We honour the delineation of the different waters and zones defined within UNCLOS. Except for the U.S. the other Arctic states are all signatories.

Our EEZ and continental shelf claims overlap with Canada, Norway, and Russia. We must keep our interests on the rightful ownership of these areas governed by international law. We must define more clearly our marine areas and boundaries in the Arctic. The former dispute with Canada over Hans Ø proves that diplomacy works. The process we used for that dispute can work in other disputed areas.

Our submission to CLCS show direct geologic and geographic linkages between the Lomonosov Ridge and Grønland. Any continued claim by Canada or Russia to their rights to the ridge are not valid. Do not let the recent CLCS validation of Russian claims be viewed as a final decision by the CLCS. Russia may claim this but we have to push back on this as the CLCS has even stated that it is not an adjudication of the matter.

Militarization

The increased militarization of the Arctic threatens the current peace and stability in the region. With growing access to seaways and traditionally permafrost areas, military operations are becoming easier to conduct.

We need to work, through international organizations, to ensure peace continues. We must encourage NATO to increase its collective capacity to conduct Arctic operations, along with highlighting the need for all NATO allies to assist in protecting member states from external aggression. Our lack of surveillance assets to monitor Grønland reduces our ability to detect, track, and monitor traffic around the island.

The U.S. Pituffik Space Base at Nuuk is mutually beneficial for Greenlanders and Denmark. The air base strengthens our ties with Grønland by providing security and financial incentives. Through the agreement we reduce the likelihood of future Grønland initiatives for full independence. It also proves that we represent Grønland internationally and our current political arrangement is working.

In 2016 China worked on agreements to purchase an old military base on Grønland. We denied their attempts to establish a foothold on the island. This has not deterred their ambitions in the region. Chinese and Russian vessels have repeatedly transited to/within Grønland waters without notification, or proper protocols. In 2006 a submarine was spotted by reindeer hunters off the coast. In 2017 a Chinese icebreaker appeared in Grønland waters and when spotted turned around and proceeded to depart the area.

Red Line:

Any Chinese military presence on Grønland or in its surrounding waters.

Resources

Where there are disputes between nations over EEZs the parties should resolve their differences through dialog and within the constructs of international law. No third-party governance of the Arctic is required.

The EEZ surrounding Grønland do not fall within the EU's Common Fisheries Policy.

Mineral and non-mineral resources within Grønland must only be explored, or extracted, by express permission of the Grønland Government. This currently applies to the land and waters out to 3 nautical miles from Grønland. Outside of this, to the EEZ and our continental shelf claim, the Danish Government holds the exclusive rights to develop the resources within.

Resources within the Grønland economic sphere are for domestic development and distribution. We have agreed with Grønland, through the Naalakkersuisut (Grønland Self-rule Government), the right to develop their domestic economy as they see fit. A Chinese-owned company currently holds a license to mine Uranium. The decision to grant a license was based on contract bids reviewed by the Naalakkersuisut. We must balance our relationship with the U.S. and the autonomy of Grønland to manage its own resources.

Look to develop agreements where sustainable extraction of resources can be accomplished within our EEZ around Grønland. Financial gains from resources extracted can help minimize the burden of Grønland on the Danish economy.

Red Line:

Any agreements made by other states regarding licenses within the Danish EEZ.

Environment

All nations must adhere to the Paris Climate Agreement and take further actions to reduce carbon emissions. The ice cover over much of Grønland has been greatly affected by climate change. To preserve this ecosystem, we insist that China and the U.S., the two largest carbon emitters, take more aggressive action to reduce their carbon footprint.

Tourism, second only to fisheries, is the most important industry in Grønland. The tourist industry is growing through both to land-based and the cruise-liner business. This growth is due, in part, to the Arctic features that tourists desire to see. The melting of the glacial cover affects the draw for this essential industry.

Canada ranks 7th in oil production yet claims to be very concerned about the environment and global warming. Norway, ranked 15th, has promoted environmental sustainability while continuing to extract and export oil around the world. Stating 'green' policies on one hand and yet economically benefiting off the largest environmental threat is very hypocritical.

Our fishing areas are directly impacted by Arctic Ocean stocks and their protection. Monitoring of the commercial fishing ban must be a multilateral effort of the nine nation signatories. The joint programme of scientific monitoring must continue to inform decisions on extension of this moratorium.

Governance

We have a firm tradition of cooperation with our Arctic neighbors while prioritising other relevant collaborations globally, regionally, and bilaterally. We feel that the Arctic Council should be

strengthened in its cooperation and dispute resolving. We will retain the Arctic 5 format for issues primarily relevant for the five coastal Arctic states.

We must push for full inclusion of Grønland and Færøerne (Faroe Islands) on the Arctic Council. Since their removal in 2011, and reinstatement in 2013, the other members have not granted full diplomatic courtesies to them. We have arranged to include them in discussions at the Senior Arctic Officials meetings. Though this conference is not an Arctic Council meeting you need to secure support from those member states present.

We support EU observer status on the Arctic Council. As an EU member state, we see the whole of Europe as having interest in the development of the Arctic. It is logical to include Brussels on the Arctic Council as an observer.

We do not support China's accession to full member state status on the Arctic Council. These positions on the Council should be reserved for Arctic states only. No matter how much interest or investment in the Arctic, China is not an Arctic state. The Ottawa Declaration clearly states that members are "the Arctic States" which China clearly is not.

Red Line:

Any attempt to make China a member state of the Arctic Council.

Population

The Self-rule Government of Grønland is a model of inspiration for many of the world's indigenous peoples. We have structured this arrangement, with the people of Grønland, in granting them autonomy to maintain their way of life and culture.

Through the Naalakkersuisut we have allowed Grønland to influence their own path economically. Their choice to not join the EU, even though we are a member, due to their differences with the EU's policies on common waters, was solely their decision. We support this decision as it affects Grønlanders and their way of life.